

THE PROS AND CONS OF E-BOOKS



Potshangbam July

It was in 2012 that the electronic book, or e-book, made its foray into the Indian market. Amazon introduced its reading device Kindle in India a few years after its launch in the US in November 2007. But the

origin goes back much further. The wave of the e-book was originally initiated by Project Gutenberg founder Michael S. Hart, who created the first ever e-book in 1971.

However, years that followed did not witness any dramatic transition in reading habits of the readers. In India too, e-books failed to stir the enthusiasm of readers instantly, when it was launched. The concept was viewed with skepti-

cism as readers considered physical books to be better for an immersive reading. They felt an acute vacuum in e-books—the smell of paper and feel of reading real books.

Interestingly, the scenario of e-books has changed over the years, slowly and steadily, in India. With an explosive growth of smartphones, tablets and reading apps, there has been an overall surge in the con-